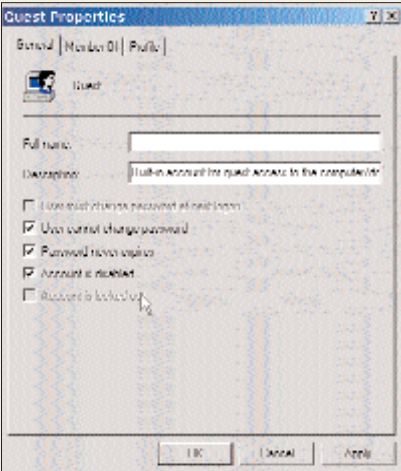


Windows NT/2000

Windows NT/2000 offer a more secure environment, though a few exploits can let other users gain access to your machine. Here's how to plug those holes

Restricting guest access

Unauthorised users can access your Win2K PC by specifying Guest in the logon window. To disable the Guest account, open Users and Passwords from

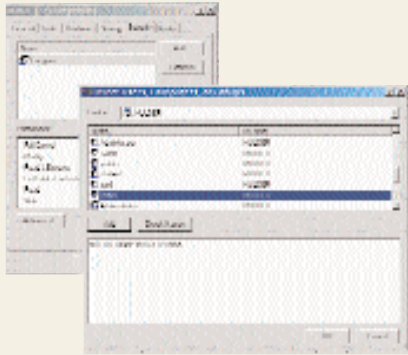


No Guests please!

the Control Panel. Click on the Advanced button twice to display the Local Users and Groups window. In the left pane, double-click on Users. Here, right-click on Guest and choose Properties. Once there, disable all options by clicking in the check box against each.

Encrypting and securing drives

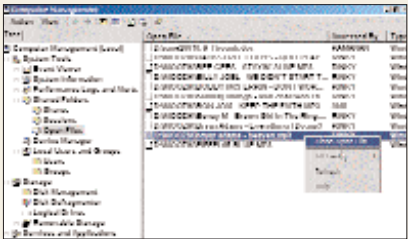
In Windows 2000 or NT, if you are using the NTFS file system for a drive, you can restrict access to selected users. To secure your drive, right-click on the NTFS partition and choose Properties to display the Drive Properties. Click on the Security tab and then click on the Add button to display the 'Add Users, Computers or Groups' window. In the upper part of the window, click on the users you want to allow access to and press Add. Repeat this if you want to add more than one user.



Encrypt drives for greater security

Watching your shares-I

If you have kept some important documents for, say, your boss in one of your shared folders, then someone else who isn't supposed to read that can open it if you haven't set the right permissions. Unlike Windows 95/98, Windows 2000 allows you to close the files that have been opened by unauthorised users without unsharing the folders that contain them. To do this, right-click on the My Computer icon on the desktop and choose Manage. In the window that



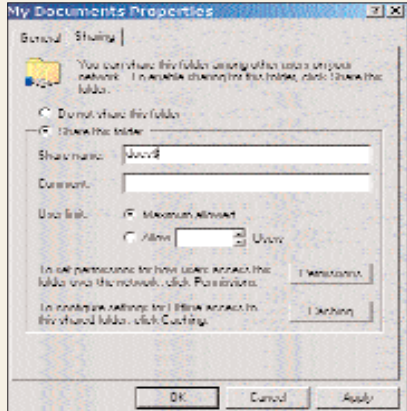
Close unwanted network connections

opens, click on Shared Folders and then on Open Files. In the right pane you should now be able to see all the files from your machine that have been opened by various users. Simply right-click on the file that you want to close and choose Close Open File.

Watching your shares-II

The above method is quite effective, but the unauthorised user can again open the same file if he wants to, because the folder that contains the file is still shared. Use the following method to share

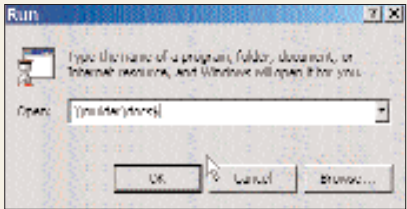
folders selectively—it ensures that only the person who knows the exact name of the folder can access it. Open Windows Explorer and click on the folder you want to share. Now right-click on it and choose Sharing to display the properties window for that particular folder. Click on the check box against 'Share this folder'. In the Share Name option, put any name and add the '\$' sign at the end. For example, you can give the share name 'DOCS\$'. Now, if you want your boss to read a



\$ is the key!

document in that folder, just tell him to access it using the Run menu and not through Network Neighborhood because folders that are shared using the '\$' technique can only be accessed through a Windows command line like the Run menu.

In the Run menu your boss will have to type \machine name\DOCS\$. To check whether you have done this correctly,



Access \$ folders using command line

type \machine name with and then without the folder name. In the first case, you will see the folder while in the second case, you will not.

Ad will come